ETHAN MANDEL

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SUMMARY

Informatics graduate with experience in technical troubleshooting, end-user support, and customer-facing problem solving. Skilled at identifying technical issues, guiding users through digital systems, and communicating solutions clearly in fast-paced environments. Academic background in programming, systems design, data privacy, and user-centered technology.

EDUCATION

University of California, Irvine Irvine, CA

Bachelor of Science, Informatics – Specialization in Human-Computer Interaction GPA: 3.81 Graduated June 2025

Relevant Coursework:

- Systems & Programming: IN4MATX 148 (IoT systems, physical computing, smart device prototyping), IN4MATX 121 (system design, object-oriented design), I&C SCI 45C (C/C++ programming, memory management), I&C SCI 45J (Java, object-oriented programming)
- Data & Privacy: IN4MATX 174 (SQL, data analysis, data privacy)
- Systems Development & Requirements: IN4MATX 172 (project-based systems development), IN4MATX 113 (stakeholder requirements, user research)
- User Interaction: IN4MATX 131, 132, 133 (user-centered design, usability testing, interactive interfaces)

WORK EXPERIENCE

Ralphs Grocery Company Rancho Cucamonga, CA

Front-End Cashier / Department Clerk / Floor Supervisor Sep 2020 – Present

- Provide frontline support for customers using self-checkout, POS, rewards, and payment systems, identifying common system and user errors and guiding users through resolution
- Troubleshoot transaction and workflow issues in real time while determining when problems require additional support or escalation
- Explain digital tools and system processes clearly to customers with varying levels of technical familiarity
- Resolve customer concerns professionally in a high-volume environment while balancing technical problems with operational needs
- Collaborate with team members across departments to maintain efficient daily operations and consistent service

Independent Technical Support Rancho Cucamonga, CA

2018 – Present

- Provide in-person and remote technical support for Windows, macOS, Linux, mobile devices, printers, and peripherals
- Diagnose and resolve hardware and software issues, including boot failures, blue screens, driver errors, malware, OS installation, device configuration, and peripheral setup
- Build and troubleshoot PCs, including component installation, RAM/GPU reseating, cabling, and hardware diagnosis
- Guide nontechnical users through troubleshooting using clear verbal instructions, screen sharing, and remote assistance

UNIVERSITY PROJECTS

Laguna Ocean Foundation Website Redesign

- Collaborated with a nonprofit stakeholder to gather requirements and translate organizational needs into functional website features
- Contributed to the development of a deployment-ready website through iterative design, implementation, testing, and troubleshooting
- Worked within a team-based development workflow using Figma and Trello to manage requirements, tasks, feedback, and revisions
- Conducted usability testing and identified issues affecting navigation and key user workflows

Remembra — Music-Based Memory App for Alzheimer's Care

- Worked in an interdisciplinary team with public health students to design a research-driven app focused on improving quality of life for Alzheimer's patients by combining research on music and memory into user-centered features tailored to patients and caregivers
- Developed and led interactive prototyping, collaborated on early-stage implementation, and created a demo-ready website to showcase user flows and overall experience

SKILLS

Hardware/Software Troubleshooting • Windows • macOS • Linux • PC Hardware • Microsoft Office • Adobe Creative Suite • HTML/CSS • Python • C++ • Java • SQL